

# Space stations

Space stations allow astronauts to live and work in orbit for long periods of time. From simple laboratories made from adapted rocket casings, they have grown into permanent communities of scientists who carry out experiments, manufacture materials, observe Earth, and study the effects of long-duration spaceflight on the human body.

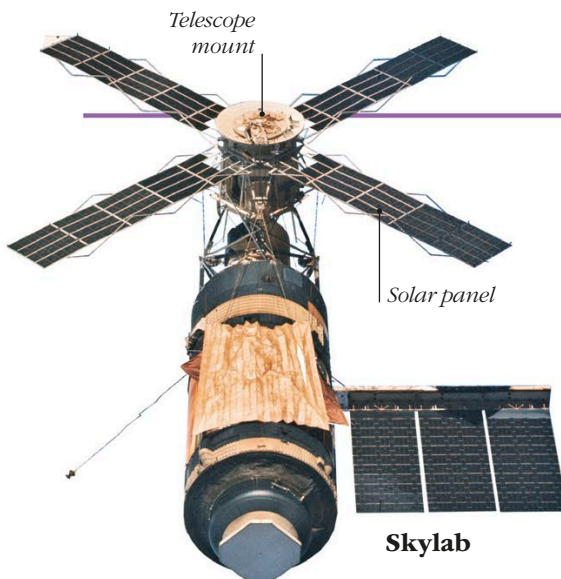
## Salyut 1

- **What?** Salyut 1
- **Who?** Soviet Space Agency
- **Where and when?** Russia, 1971

The first space station, Salyut 1, was launched by Russia in 1971. This simple cylindrical laboratory had a docking port for a Soyuz spacecraft, and was visited by the three-man crew of Soyuz 11 for 23 days in June 1971—the longest spaceflight up to that time. However, the station was abandoned after the Soyuz 11 crew died in an accident during their return to Earth.



Interior of Salyut 1 space station

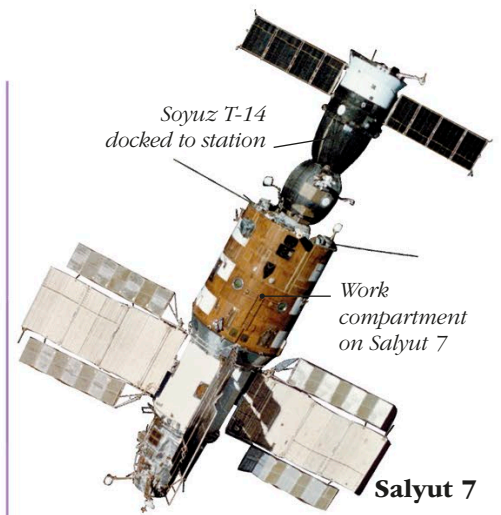


Skylab

## Skylab

- **What?** Skylab
- **Who?** NASA
- **Where and when?** US, crewed 1973–1974

Skylab, the first American space station, was constructed from an empty Saturn rocket stage and hosted three crews during nine months of operation. It carried an ultraviolet telescope for observing the sun, as well as equipment modules for carrying out a range of experiments into life and chemistry in the weightless environment of space.



## Advanced Salyuts

- **What?** Salyut 6 and 7
- **Who?** Soviet Space Agency
- **Where and when?** Russia, 1982–1991

The Salyut 6 and 7 space stations had a docking port at both ends, allowing a new crew to arrive before the old one departed. Salyut 7 also tested the idea of “hard docking”—extending the working area of the station by permanently attaching an unmanned tug spacecraft to one end.

